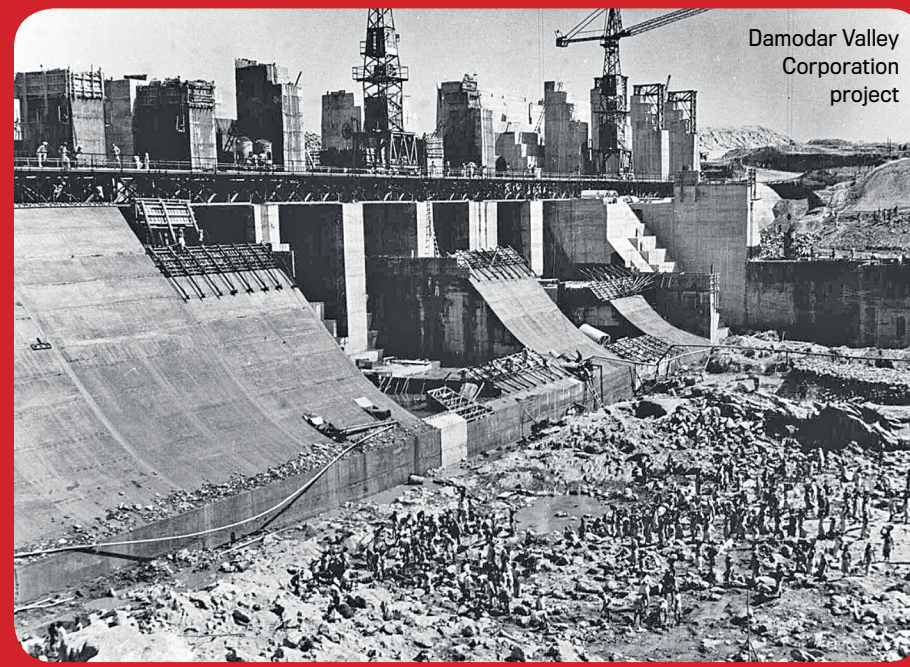
Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan and Gujarat, in addition to generating hydroelectric power for these states.

The Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC), which operates in the Damodar river area of West Bengal and Jharkhand, came into existence on July 7, 1948. It was the first multipurpose river valley project of independent India–formed with the central government and the governments of Bihar (later Jharkhand) and West Bengal participating in it. The project aimed at flood control, irrigation, generation and transmission of electricity and year-round navigation. Such projects were early demonstrators of the massive economic impact that large public works projects had.



Damodar Valley Corporation project

INDIA PICTURE



INDIA PICTURE

Konkan Railway

First train ran in 1998

The Konkan coast of India did not have a railway link for most of the modern era. The Konkan Railway, one of the 19 railway zones in India, was conceived to bridge this gap. The 756.25-km-long railway line connects Maharashtra, Goa and Karnataka. The first train on the completed track ran on January 26, 1998. The project was one of the most challenging in the history of Indian Railways, and the man then at the helm, E. Sreedharan, is famed for having completed it in record time. The project involved over 2,116 bridges (of which the Panvalnadi bridge was the highest viaduct in India till 2010) and 92 tunnels and was the largest railway project of the century in Asia.

Mumbai-Pune Expressway

Fully operationalised in 2002

The Mumbai-Pune Expressway (officially Yashwantrao Chavan Expressway) is India's first six-lane-wide, concrete, access-controlled toll expressway. Spanning a distance of 94.5 km, it has reduced travel time by two hours, in comparison to the old highway. The expressway, which was fully operationalised in 2002, introduced new levels of speed and safety in automobile transportation to Indian roads and remains one of India's busiest roads currently. It handles about 43,000 passenger cars daily and is designed to handle up to 100,000. It was one of the first iconic road projects that used the principle of "build by sovereign, then monetise by private capital".



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